



Golden Eagle Trans-Siberian Express



1916

The world's longest railroad line, the Trans-Siberian Railway across Russia, is completed. It runs for 5,772 miles (9,289 km).

1937

German inventor Hermann Kemper develops magnetic levitation (maglev) as a force for moving trains.

1960

French Railways introduce the world's first 125 mph (200 km/h) service—the Le Capitole.

1964

The world's first bullet train, Shinkansen, connects Tokyo to other cities of Japan.

1984

In the UK, the first commercial maglev transportation system opens, connecting Birmingham International Airport and nearby terminals.

2012

Tokyo metro carries 3.29 billion passengers in a year, making it the busiest metro system in the world.

1994

The high-speed Channel Tunnel Eurostar service begins from London to Paris.

1950

2000

1955

Initial trials of the English Electric *Deltic*—the most powerful diesel locomotive in the world—take place.

1975

In the UK, the Inter-City HST becomes the fastest diesel-powered train in the world.

2007

An experimental French TGV sets the world record for the fastest electric train, with a speed of 357 mph (574 km/h).

1938

The *Mallard* sets the world record for the fastest-ever steam locomotive, at a speed of more than 125 mph (200 km/h).

2015

First passenger-carrying test run of Japan's new maglev train system. Trains reach speeds of 373 mph (600 km/h).

1988 The world's longest underwater railroad tunnel, the Seikan Tunnel, 33.5 miles (53.9 km) long, is built to connect two Japanese islands.

